

RACHEL S. BAILEY, M.U.P.

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Dear Hiring Manager:

I am pleased to submit my qualifications for planning opportunities. I hold a Master of Urban Planning from the University at Buffalo, with graduate training in land use and physical planning, urban design, environmental planning, GIS, transportation planning, housing and community development, and economic development. My professional background complements that education with planning-related experience in affordable housing development, community development, stakeholder engagement, research and data analysis, and project and program management.

My graduate work crossed several planning disciplines and included community planning, land use and development, GIS and demographic analysis, urban design, environmental planning, and neighborhood revitalization. A graduate planning studio project examining the reuse of a former rail corridor as a neighborhood asset also gave me experience considering land use, connectivity, community access, environmental conditions, and economic activation as interconnected planning issues.

My professional experience gives me a practical perspective on community development and project implementation. As Housing Development Manager/Project Manager with Northeast Hawley Development Association, I managed more than \$2 million in neighborhood-based affordable housing development from site selection through construction and sale. I coordinated RFPs, proposals and grants, contractors, budgets, HUD requirements, schedules, community outreach, and public and nonprofit partners. My more recent housing and community-services work has further strengthened my experience working with residents, government agencies, housing providers, community organizations, and other stakeholders.

I bring strong research, writing and communication skills, experience coordinating complex projects and multiple stakeholders, and an understanding of the relationship between planning, development, and community needs. I am interested in opportunities where I can apply this combination of formal planning education and related professional experience while continuing to develop my technical planning skills and contribute to thoughtful, community-focused planning work.

Thank you for considering my qualifications. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my background and planning portfolio.

Sincerely,

Rachel S. Bailey, M.U.P.